

Tracked Infantry Fighting Vehicles (cont.)

The Soviet BMP-1 set the template for IFV design. The infantry it carried could fire their own weapons from inside the vehicle, while it had a powerful main gun and an antitank missile launcher of its own. It also had much thicker armor than an APC. Western nations followed the Soviet example, although firing ports were less common: firing from them was deemed impractical, and many users eventually covered them with extra armor.



△ M2 Bradley

Date	1983	Country	USA
Weight	35.4 tons (32.1 tonnes)		
Engine	Cummins VTA-903T diesel, 600 hp		
Main armament	25 mm M242 cannon		

The M2 Bradley suffered from a troubled and protracted development, but proved itself in combat. Its TOW antitank missile launcher is particularly popular with its three crew and six infantrymen. Upgrades have improved its armor, sights, and electronic systems, and added space for a seventh infantryman.



One of five firing ports

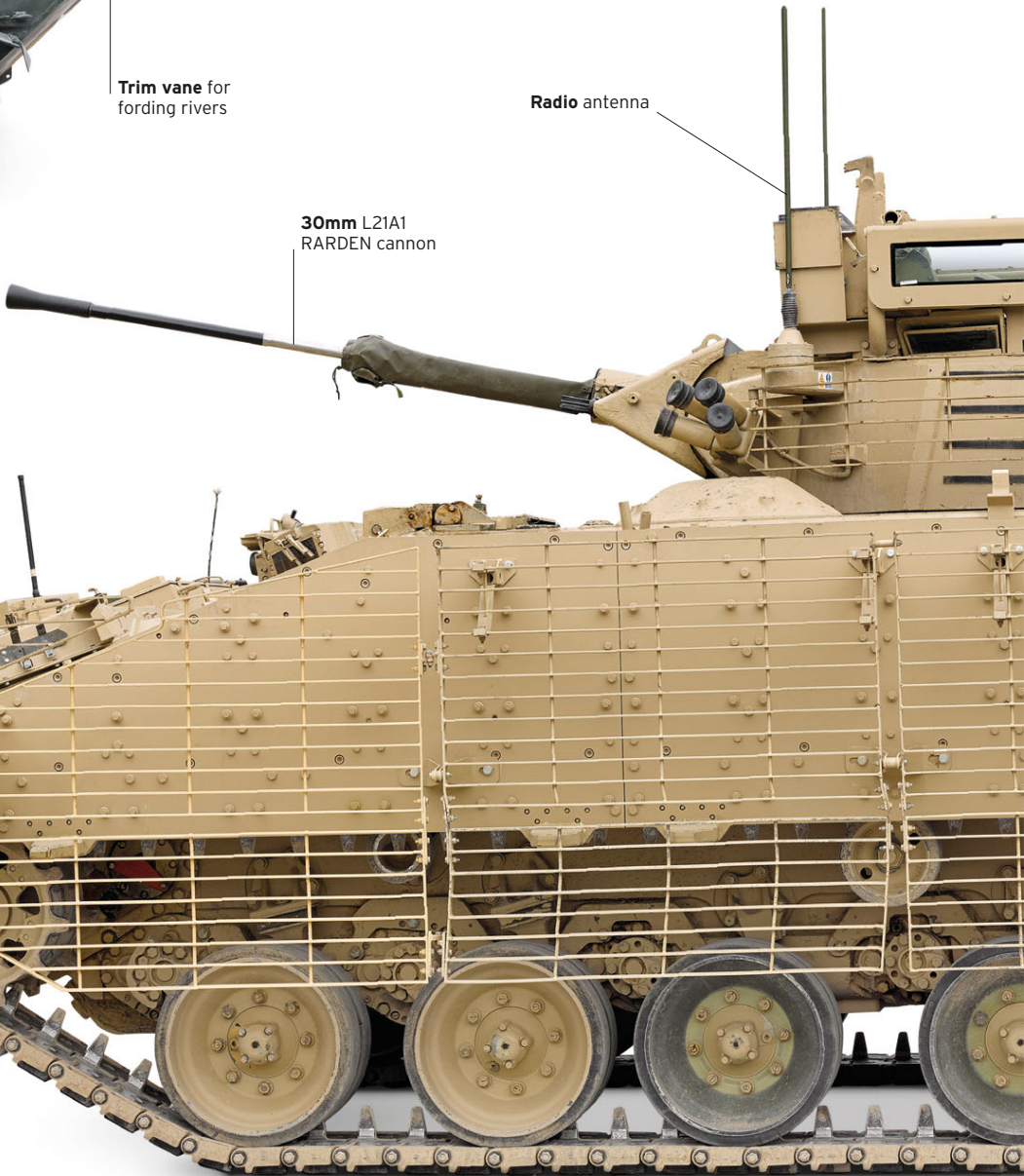
30 mm 2A42 cannon

Trim vane for fording rivers

△ BMD-2

Date	1985	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	9.1 tons (8.2 tonnes)		
Engine	5D-20 diesel, 240 hp		
Main armament	30 mm 2A42 cannon		

A Soviet Airborne Troops IFV, the BMD-2 is an improved version of the BMD-1. It has a slightly modified hull and a new turret, with high elevation for the cannon. However, its armor is still thin—protection against little more than machine-gun bullets and shrapnel.



Radio antenna

30mm L21A1 RARDEN cannon

Roadside bomb protection device

▷ Warrior

Date	1986	Country	UK
Weight	30.9 tons (28 tonnes)		
Engine	Perkins CV-8 TCA diesel, 550 hp		
Main armament	30 mm L21A1 RARDEN cannon		

The Warrior IFV (FV510) originally carried seven infantry. In the upgraded version seen here this was reduced to six, although the seats provided better protection against mine blasts. Suspension and crew visibility were also improved. Extra armor and electronic countermeasures were added for service in the Gulf, the Balkans, and Afghanistan. Command post, repair, and recovery variants have since been developed.